QUICK GUIDE

RESONANCE CONTROL

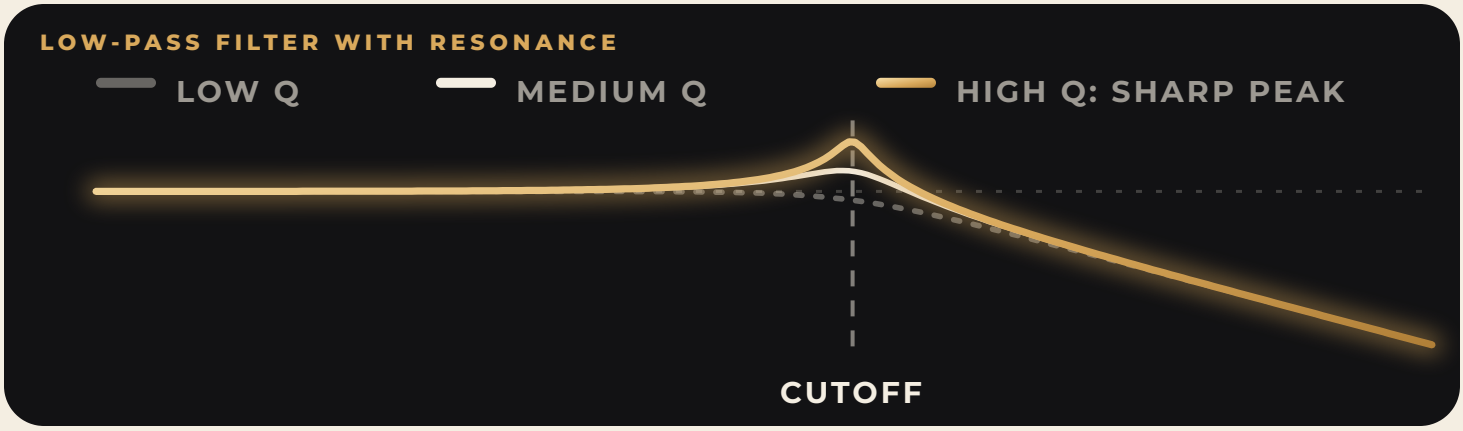
What it is, how to spot it and what to do with it.

WHAT IT IS

Resonance, sometimes called Q, boosts the frequencies right around a filter's cutoff point. The higher the resonance, the sharper the peak and the more obvious the filter effect.

HOW IT SOUNDS

Low: smooth and natural. High: sharp, whistling and dramatic.



01

LOW RESONANCE

A smooth, natural sweep. Great for blending.

02

MEDIUM RESONANCE

Clear and punchy. The sweet spot for most mixes.

03

HIGH RESONANCE

A sharp peak. Big energy, but it can get harsh.

DO THIS TONIGHT

Raise resonance slowly while you sweep the cutoff to build tension.

- [ ] Start with low resonance and sweep the cutoff slowly.
- [ ] Raise the resonance a little as you build toward the drop.
- [ ] Bring it back down as the drop lands so it doesn't get harsh.



PRACTICE & CHECK

RESONANCE CONTROL: YOUR TURN

WHERE YOU'LL MEET IT AS A DJ

- Filter sweeps that build into a drop.
- Isolating one part of a track, like a vocal or a snare, with a band-pass filter.
- Creating unusual textures and effects.

QUICK CHECK

1. What does resonance boost?

2. What happens when resonance is very high?

3. When do you raise it?

Answer key: 1) The frequencies around the cutoff point. 2) A sharp peak that can sound harsh. 3) Slowly, during a build.

REMEMBER

Sweep the cutoff. Nudge the resonance. Keep it musical.

YOUR NOTES

UP NEXT EQ and Filter Combo

